Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Country Specific Requirements Netherlands

Document Number: IQMS-87265
SSC-PTC-SOP-NL-003

Version: 7.0

Effective Date:	2025-12-12
QMS Area:	Quality
QMS Chapter:	4.9 Product Safety, Product Quality and Pharmacovigilance

Applicability

Bayer Level:	CH, PH

This document is electronically approved (signatures on the last page)

Distribution Sheet for Quality Regulations

Division/Business Unit ☒ PH ☒ CH

GBS Location
☐ Global Business Services Barcelona
☐ Global Business Services Costa Rica/Brazil
☐ Global Business Services Manila
☒ Global Business Services Gdansk
☐ Global Business Services India
☐ Global Business Services Dalian
☐ Global Business Services Germany

Region/ Country
☐ Global
☒ Specific Country: Netherlands

Relevance for R&D QMS
☐ Affected
☐ Interface
☒ N/A

Version:	7.0
Document Author(s):	Damian Roslonowski (GOHHV)
Document Approver(s):	CQH: Daan Odink (GIDCR) PTC Team Leader/SME: Katarzyna Mazur-Kominek (GLISG)
Training Role(s):	GBS_GDN_PTC_CLUSTER 4
Relevant Process and Activities:	PTC

Table of contents

1 Scope and Framework 5
1.1 Scope 5
1.2 Framework 5
2 Abbreviations 5
3 Purpose & Set-Up 5
3.1 Purpose 5
3.2 General guidance 5
3.3 Roles and responsibilities 6
4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling 7
4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics 7
5 Internal References 12
6 External References 12
History of Changes 13
Annexes 16
Annex 1 16
Annex 2 16
Annex 3 16
Annex 4 16

1 Scope and Framework

1.1 Scope

Bayer Country Quality Units are accountable for a GMP compliant Product Technical Complaint Management within their respective countries. Within this responsibility they are supported by the respective Global Business Service in process steps like complaint initiation, classification forwarding for investigation to the RQU, and final approval including complaint sample management and reimbursement process.

This SOP defines clear guidance to the Global Business Service regarding all country specific requirements.

1.2 Framework

This SOP is based on principles and requirements outlined in SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

2 Abbreviations

AE	Adverse Event
CMO	Contract Manufacturing Organization
CQH	Country Quality Head
CQU	Country Quality Unit
GBS	Global Business Service
OTC products	Over-the-counter products
PTC	Product Technical Complaint
PV	Pharmacovigilance
RQU	Responsible Quality Unit

3 Purpose & Set-Up

3.1 Purpose

Country Specific Requirements for the Netherlands are described in this SOP, regarding e.g. Data Privacy, Sample Handling Process, Reimbursement Process, Contacts, escalation rules.

During the processing of all PTCs by Bayer owned Global Business Service all country specific requirements are considered and followed besides the general complaint handling described in the SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaint and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”.

3.2 General guidance

The employees of Global Business Services follow the SOP during complaint processing in the complaint database on behalf of the Country Quality Units.

3.3 Roles and responsibilities

Brocacef Healthcare Services (BHS)	- Responsible for complaint sample handling and sending of samples to the RQU if requested - IUD samples: Sending of suitable packaging material for sample retrieval to complainant
GBS team	- Enters PTCs, Suspected Counterfeit Incidents and Usability Issues according to defined timelines in a timely manner, entering them into the global complaint database in English language - Organizes missing information and asks CQU for any support contacting the complainant if not possible/allowed by GBS (e.g. data privacy, non-hosted language) - Performs the initial intake of complaints after receipt - Informs the CQU about all PTCs where local authorities are involved, about all potential counterfeits and any other cases described in this SOP - Informs PV about all PTCs with a potential associated AE or LODE or potentially reportable medical device complaints, including the unique complaint database number and all relevant follow-up information - Forwards the case to the respective RQU for further assessment - Initiates the process of sample shipment if requested by RQU or specified in any other guidance document - Reviews the case for plausibility and closes the complaint case in the complaint database - Sends out standard response letters in case it is agreed with the CQU - Supports the process for reimbursement management - Forwards all cases that are not PTCs back to the CQU or to the appropriate function for further processing
Country Quality Head (CQH) / Country Quality Unit (CQU)	- Is responsible for regular KPI evaluation to get an overview of complaint activities at the GBS - Supports the GBS in organizing missing complaint information - Sends out the Response Letters to the complainants as requested and agreed with GBS - Contacts local CMO on request of GBS as RQU to get investigation reports from the respective CMO - Ensures that all changes within the country law and regulation are directly notified to the GBS and that the Country Specific SOP is updated

4 Specific requirements regarding PTC handling

4.1 Country Specific Requirements listed by different topics

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
4.1.1 General Information In the Netherlands the company operates under one legal entity with distributor status: Bayer B.V. The main office is in Hoofddorp.	
4.1.2 Contact list CQH NL: daan.odink@bayer.com CQH Deputy NL: eline.detobel@bayer.com General e-mail CQU: nl.quality@bayer.com **Remark:** Current name and e-mail address of CQH and CQH deputy are found on the Quality International SharePoint (*QINT*).	
4.1.3 Escalation Rules The CQH and the CQH deputy should be notified via notification in the complaint database about any complaint case referring to at least one of the following situations: - Suspected Counterfeit Cases - Any cases involving Health Authorities: - Medicines Evaluation Board (*MEB*) - Health and Youth Care Inspectorate (*IGJ*) - Netherlands Food and Consumer Product Safety Authority (*NVWA*) - Cases with final risk category high or medium (escalation via immediate action) In case of questions or comments which are not classified as PTC, this information is forwarded to: nl.consumerhealth@bayer.com (CH products) or to nl.medicalinfo@bayer.com (PH products) for further handling. **Remark:** The current names and e-mail addresses of the CQH and the CQH deputy are found on the Quality International SharePoint (*QINT*).	GBS
4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases If a complaint case is related to any type of Adverse Event, the Pharmacovigilance department has to be informed via: drugsafety.benelux@bayer.com.	GBS
4.1.5 Product Samples **Intrauterine devices (IUDs)** The complainant must be instructed on how to handle contaminated IUD samples in case a sample is available for investigation. The complainant will be provided with instructions via e-mail by GBS officer for shipping the IUD sample and GBS officer will	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

inform BHS (adminbhs@brocacef.nl) to ship suitable packaging material to retrieve the sample from the address indicated by the complainant. GBS officer updates the Excel tracker "*List received samples*" with all necessary information required for BHS to handle the IUD sample. For a standard sample shipment template with instructions for handling contaminated IUDs, see Annex 1 (Sample shipment).

All other PTCs

In order to retrieve a sample, GBS officer asks the complainant to send the sample to the given BHS address:

Bayer B.V. Quality Assurance
Referentie "*SSF*"
Antwoordnummer 617
2130 WB Hoofddorp*

* Delivery address linked to this "return mail" concerns the BHS site.

Before sending the request for the sample shipment to the complainant, the reference field "*SSF*" has to be filled with corresponding SSF number. Always inform BHS that the sample will be sent to the BHS site by means of entering the data in the Excel tracker "List received samples". In the Netherlands there is a "return mail" system available. Shipments can be sent to this specific address free of charge. The owner of this "return mail", in this case Bayer B.V. Netherlands, pays for the costs of shipments that have been received on this specific address. A standard sample shipment template is attached in Annex 1 (Sample shipment). In case of questions, BHS can be contacted via adminbhs@brocacef.nl.

Exceptions and special cases

In case a sample has to be shipped outside the European Union, the value of the products has to be provided to BHS by entering this data in the Excel tracker "List received samples". The value of the products can be provided for PH/CH by contacting customerservice.nl@bayer.com and beneluxcustomersupport@bayer.com for RAD.

4.1.6 Statement letter — GBS

Acknowledgement Letter when a complaint comes in:

After a complaint is handed in, an immediate acknowledgement of receipt is sent out to the complainant. If there are missing data in the initial complaint (e.g., batch number), the acknowledgment letter will be expanded with the request for providing missing data by the complainant. Standard templates are added in Annex 2 (Acknowledgement letter).

Response Letter after closing:

Standard response letters for unconfirmed case are sent out to complainant without involvement of the CQU. Response letters for confirmed cases are sent out by the CQU. In case a sales representative or account manager is involved in the complaint handling and would like to provide the answer to the complainant, the standard response letter is provided to him/her. Standard templates are added below in Annex 3 (Response letters).

Exceptions:

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference
# All communications with Health Authorities are handled by CQH. # Unconfirmed cases where complainant asks questions that cannot be answered with standard templates	
4.1.7 RQU Contact list A table with all available products in the country, needed for entry into the complaint database, is available on SharePoint: go/ptcops. For CH products registration status in the respective country as well as Manufacturing Site are available via SYNAPS: go/synaps. List with the respective RQU contact names are provided by the Divisional Quality Assurance function and available on the SharePoint: PH: *PH RQU responsible list_HJ.xlsx* CH: *IQMS_MASTER LIST COMPLAINT RESPONSIBILITIES.xlsx*	GBS
4.1.8 List of Local Opportunities Products n/a	
4.1.9 Data Privacy Requirements The Netherlands and Poland are both members of the European Union, hence there are no restrictions in personal data flow. Every e-mail should contain a data privacy statement.	
4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) In case when the CQU receives a complaint by phone, then sends all details to GBS via e-mail as soon as possible, because the timeline starts when the phone complaint is received by the CQU. Written complaints will be placed either in Dutch or English language. Complaints have to be translated by contacting Bayer Service Translation Office as Dutch is not a hosted language. If a situation occurs where only a phone number is provided with a complaint and information is missing (e.g., batch number), contact CQU and ask for support in calling the complainant. In cases when the use of Dutch communication templates provided in Annexes are not sufficient to receive necessary information from the consumer, client, or other reporter, GBS Team uses Bayer AI machine translator to provide the required message in Dutch. The message is sent with Dutch text using a template with the statement attached, provided in Annex 4.	GBS CQU
4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement **Intrauterine devices (IUDs)** In these cases, reimbursement will only be provided in case the complaint is confirmed after PTC investigation. In general complaints for IUDs are reported by general practitioners, gynecologists, midwifes or customers which are not allowed to receive	GBS

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

reimbursement directly from Bayer. In these cases, the pharmacy which supplied the IUD is credited through the wholesaler which ordered the original IUD. As these cases require some explanation and instructions, these cases are forwarded to the CQU (nl.quality@bayer.com) for further handling. Information about the reimbursement is included in Annex 2 and 3.

All other PTCs

Whether reimbursement for a product is granted, depends on sample availability and the division.

Pharma Products

In case of Bayer Pharma products, reimbursement will be granted only if it concerns 1 package and if the sample is available for investigation.

Complaints from (hospital) pharmacies and wholesalers:

If the complainant has ordered the product directly from Bayer, they will be credited directly. Complaints from indirect customers are credited through the wholesaler from which they ordered. Reimbursement can be requested by sending an e-mail to customerservice.nl@bayer.com and customersolutions.nl@bayer.com including:

- Name of the product
- Name of the wholesaler that supplied the product (if not supplied directly)
- Name of the (hospital)pharmacy (if applicable)
- Name of the complainant and contact information (e.g. e-mail and/or phone)

Complaints from patients, physicians or others:

Bayer is not able and allowed to reimburse these individuals directly. If a replacement or reimbursement is requested, the complaint and sample should be returned to the pharmacy that supplied the product to the complainant. The pharmacy should subsequently contact Bayer with the complaint reference (SSF number) for further instructions for the sample return and to start reimbursement. As these cases require some explanation and instructions, these cases are forwarded to the CQU (nl.quality@bayer.com) for further handling.

Consumer Health Products

Bayer Consumer Health product reimbursement is handled by the CQU or Consumer Health division:

- Medicinal Products: Forward complaint along with contact information of the complainant and information what product is affected via e-mail to nl.quality@bayer.com.
- Medical Devices, Food Supplements and Cosmetics: Forward complaint along with contact information of the complainant and information what product is affected via e-mail to nl.consumerhealth@bayer.com.

Radiology Products

Reimbursement for non-medicinal Radiology products (medical devices) is handled by the Radiology business unit. Forward the complaint along with contact information of complainant and the product that is affected to beneluxcustomersupport@bayer.com.

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

Medicinal Radiology Products (contrast media) are handled according to Pharma Products as described above.

4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translations GBS

For all countries where the complaints are sent out for translation to the translation tool, once a year mandatory spot checks must be performed. 5% of all complaint numbers per year should be checked by a native speaker (based on random selection), e.g. CQU. Important is to check the “original income text” with “translated text” provided by translation provider.

The GBS is the owner of the process and start this action. The GBS leads the process, picks the cases and inform the CQU. The CQU checks the translation and indicates the deviations.

Acceptance Criteria:

- No Major translation deviations
- Total number of Minor translation deviations is less than 5%.

Deviations in the translation can be described as Minor or Major.

- Minor translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section of a sentence has been insufficiently translated, but the essence or meaning of the original message is still captured.
- Major translation deviations are deviations where a single word or short section has been incorrectly translated (for example by the introduction of a new word or exclusion of a word from the original complaint in the translated version) which results in an incorrect essence or meaning in the translation of the original message.

In case of a major translation deviation and exceeding 5% minor cases, the GBS will be informed promptly to open a deviation in the complaint database and to ensure appropriate CAPAs.

In addition, the translation office needs to be informed.

4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases

Complaints concerning I- NEB

GBS enters complaint concerning I-NEB in IQMS (the material number is ‘I-NEB NEBULIZER’) and forwards it to CQH for assessment (RQU country). Since Bayer is not the legal manufacturer of the device, GBS reports the complaint to the legal manufacturer of I-NEB via beneluxcustomerservices@philips.com.

4.1.14 Others

Requests for reimbursement for a Mirena/Kyleena or an exchange program

Bayer used to have a Mirena/Kyleena exchange program in place which allowed general practitioners, gynaecologists and midwifes to receive a replacement IUD. The program has been discontinued and it is not possible anymore to use this service of Bayer. In case general practitioners, gynaecologists or midwifes (but also others e.g., customers or pharmacists) want to report a PTC for Mirena/Kyleena, please use the

Description	Assigned Roles & Document Reference

acknowledgement letter as indicated in Annex 2 and adapt it with information regarding the complaint handling for IUDs.

Call center

Bayer uses the services of a call center for taking phone calls both during and outside office hours. The call center handles the call, takes notes of the call and writes down the contact information of the person calling. This information is then included in a report and forwarded via e-mail to the relevant Bayer employee. In case of a PTC and/or AE, the Bayer colleague will forward the information to the local PV department and/or the GBS.

Support Programs

A patient support program in place for Betaferon and Betaconnect. The goal of the program is to optimize patient care, minimize side effects and to increase and monitor adherence of patients. The program is managed by BHS on behalf of Bayer.

The nurses of BHS give explanations and answers questions of (new) patients about their therapy for MS (multiple sclerosis). This is in complement to the information provided by the neurologist that prescribes the products. Adherence to the therapy will be pro-actively discussed with patients by BHS. BHS also give patients practical help and information to improve adherence.

During calls or meetings that are organized by BHS, AEs or PTCs can be reported by the patient. A contract is in place between Bayer and BHS where employees of BHS are trained to recognize AEs and/or PTCs and report these per e-mail to Bayer. In case Bayer needs the sample or batch information, GBS can reach out to the BHS contact person that is mentioned in the report or e-mail.

5 Internal References

- SSC-PTC-SOP-001 “Manage Product Technical Complaints and Suspected Counterfeit Incidents in GBS”

6 External References

- N/A

History of Changes

Version	Significant changes with respect to previous version	Effective Date *(yyyy-mm-dd)*
1	New document	2020-05-20
2	# Chapter 3.3. SSC responsibilities updated. # Chapter 4.1.6 Escalation rules updated # Chapter 4.1.6 Template in country specific languages are added as a protected annex to the Country Specific SOP # Chapter 4.1.10 Described how to use Annex 1 for CQU to obtain complaint by phone # New chapter 4.1.12 Mandatory Spot Checks for Translation # Annex 1 (Product Complaint Form) added # Annex 2 (sample shipment) added # Annex 3 (Acknowledgement letter) added # Annex 4 (Response letter) added # Annex 5 (Reimbursement Program registration letter) added	2021-05-16
3	General editorial revision # Chapter 4.1.2: Included CQH deputy # Chapter 4.1.3: Added the names of the Dutch authorities for clarification and updated information about sending escalation to CH Team. #Chapter 4.1.5: Information about sample shipment of Bepanthen Cooling Foam Spray transferred from Chapter 4.1.13. # Chapter 4.1.6: Further clarified the exceptions for acknowledgement letter # Chapter 4.1.11: Revised the reimbursement process for the division Pharmaceuticals # Chapter 4.1.13: Included information about SwitchPhone, updated the description for the exchange process, added current other Patient Support Programs. # Chapter 7: Updated all Annexes: Included data privacy statements. Added clarification line for more detailed complaint explanation of complainant. Revised standard response table to include name of wholesaler and/or pharmacy. Provided a first, second and third response template.	2022-05-02
4	# Chapter 3.3, 4.1.5, 4.1.11, 4.1.14, Annex 2 and Annex 5: All PTC Sample Handling Responsibilities are transferred from the Women's Health Business Unit (IUD PTC Samples via exchange portal) and the CQU (Other PTC Samples) to Brocacef Healthcare Services.	2022-12-21

	# Chapter 4.1.1: Bayer B.V. Offices are moving from Mijdrecht to Hoofddorp. # Chapter 4.1.5 Information about sending samples outside EU # Chapter 4.1.11: Consumer Health Products Reimbursement: Update contact details # Annex 5: Criteria Exchange Program were revised # Editorial changes # Shared Service Center (SSC) name changed to Global Business Services (GBS)	
5	# Chapter 4.1.5 Product Samples updated**.** Information about sample shipment of Bepanthen Cooling Foam Spray deleted**.** # Chapter 4.1.6 Response after closing updated. #Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering additional information. Information about Bayer AI machine translator added**.** # Chapter 4.1.11 Reimbursement and Replacement; for Intrauterine devices (IUDs) and Radiology Products updated. #Chapter 4.1.13 Exceptions and special cases. Information about I-Neb complaints added. # Chapter 4.1.14 Others updated. Removal Mirena/Kyleene exchange program. Annex 2, Annex 3, Annex 4, Annex 5 updated. Data privacy statements updated.	2023-11-28
6	# Updated according to SSC-PTC-BP-002 “Country specific SOP template version 5.0 # Chapter 4.1.2 Contact list. Email address of SharePoint was changed. # Chapter 4.1.4 Pharmacovigilance cases. New email address has been added. # Chapter 4.1.14 Others. Call center was updated. Annex 3 updated.	2024-09-01
7	# Distribution sheet updated # Training role updated # Through the document, “Dev@Com” replaced by “IQMS” Roles and responsibilities updated based on SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0 # Chapter 4.1.2 Reference to QINT SharePoint updated # Chapter 4.1.3 Escalation rules: escalation on initial risk category removed, escalation regarding final risk categories changed to high and medium according to SSC-PTC-SOP-001 v.6.0. Reference to QINT SharePoint updated. # Chapter 4.1.Product samples - Intrauterine devices (IUDs), Excel link added. Exceptions and special cases updated.	See coversheet

	# Chapter 4.1.7 Updated references to global lists with RQU names for PH and CH. # Chapter 4.1.10 Gathering additional information (including obtaining translation) updated. # Chapter 4.1.14 Removal of support program for Ventavis, # Removal of Annex 1 “Product complaint form”. Annex 1, 2, 3, 4 updated.	

Annexes

Annex 1
Sample shipment


Sample shipment.docx

Annex 2
Acknowledgement letter


Acknowledgement letter.docx

Annex 3
Response letters


Response letters.docx

Annex 4
Template to be used while using Bayer AI translation.


Bayer AI translation template.docx

Task: Content Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Approval to be made Effective	Daan Odink (daan.odink@bayer.com) Approver - Content 03-Dec-2025 10:27:46 GMT+0000
Task: Final Approval Verdict: Approve changes & release Final Approval to be made Effective	katarzyna mazur kominek (katarzyna.mazur-kominek@bayer.com) Approver 08-Dec-2025 14:27:56 GMT+0000